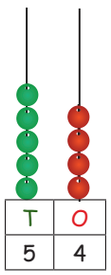
Learn

Subtraction using abacus

Sudar collected 54 seeds and used 38 seeds to form a rectangle. How many seeds are left with her?

To find the number of seeds left with Sudar we shall subract 38 from 54. We can do the subtraction 54-38 using abacus followed by the subtraction procedure. 54 has 5tens and 4ones.

So, put 5green beads in tens place and 4 red beads in ones place. To take away 38 from 54 we need to take away 3tens and 8 ones from 5 tens and 4 ones.



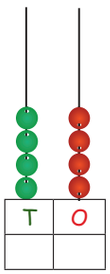
	T	O
	5	4
-	3	8

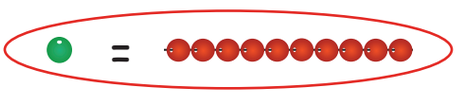
Step 1: Subtract ones

We cannot subtract 8 ones from 4 ones.

So exchange 1 ten as 10 ones.

So we have

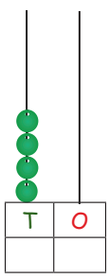


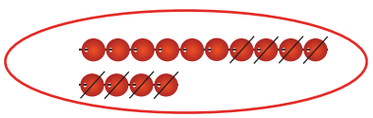


	T	O
	4	14
	~~5~~	~~4~~
-	3	8

Step 2: Cancel 8 ones from 14 ones

Now we can subtract 8 ones from 14 ones.

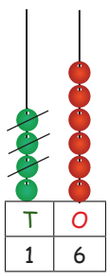




	T	O
	4	14
	~~5~~	~~4~~
-	3	8
		6

Step 3: Subtract tens

Subtract 3 tens from 4 tens.



	T	O
	4	14
	~~5~~	~~4~~
-	3	8
	1	6

So, the number of beads left with Sudar is 16.